be collected during the Census. Information on caste was last collected during British Raj in 1931. During the early census, people often exaggerated their caste status to garner social status and it is expected that people downgrade it now in the expectation of gaining government benefits.

There is only *one instance* of a caste-count in post-Independent India. It was conducted in Kerala in 1968 by the Communist government under E. M. S. Namboodiripad to assess the social and economic backwardness of various lower castes. The census was termed Socio-Economic Survey of 1968 and the results were published in the Gazetteer of Kerala, 1971.

CENSUS DATA

According to provisional results, India's population grew to 1.21 billion. The absolute number of children in the 0–6 age group recorded decline from 163 million in the 2001 census to 158 million in 2011.

Number of Administrative Units in Census 2011

- State/Union Territories: 35
- Districts: 640
- Sub-districts: 5,924
- Towns: 7,938
- Villages: 6.41 Lakh

The cost of Census 2011 has been estimated at '22,000 million, which works out to a per person cost of '18.19. A total of 2.7 million functionaries worked in the process with the census schedules in 16 languages- a total of 340 million schedules were printed.

National Population Register (NPR)

A milestone of Census 2011 is the creation of National Population Register (NPR). The National Population Register (NPR) will build up a comprehensive identity database of usual residents of the country. It would have the ***biometric data*** and ***UID Number*** of every person (15 years and